# The Oracle

THE ANSWER MACHINE

**YOU EXPECT**

truth to a hard question.

**HOW IT FAILS**

Confident plausible prose taken as fact. You asked for truth and received plausible prose.

**THE ONE RULE**

**Ask for the uncertainty before the answer. Treat the answer as a claim, not a verdict.**

**AT SCHOOL**

*(made-up example)* Revising for history, you ask for the three causes of a war and the date it ended. The date is a year out. You ask "which parts are you least sure of?" and check the date in the textbook.

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cut along the dashed line

# The Tutor

A PATH TO THE ANSWER

**YOU EXPECT**

a path to the answer, not the answer.

**HOW IT FAILS**

Being taught toward a goal you never stated.

**THE ONE RULE**

**State what you want to be able to do afterwards before the first question.**

**AT SCHOOL**

*(made-up example)* "I have a test on Friday on quadratic equations, without a calculator. I want to solve them on my own. Don't tell me the answer yet. What questions should I be asking?"

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# The Mirror

MY OWN THINKING, CLARIFIED

**YOU EXPECT**

your own thoughts back, with more clarity and structure. The value is recognition, not novelty.

**HOW IT FAILS**

Flattery mistaken for reflection.

**THE ONE RULE**

**Ask for the structure of your argument back, not for agreement.**

**AT SCHOOL**

*(made-up example)* You paste your notes for an English essay: "List the claims I make, in order, and the evidence I give for each. Don't tell me whether they are good." Two claims turn out to have no evidence.

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# The Adversary

ATTACK MY DRAFT

**YOU EXPECT**

an attack on your plan or draft: the holes found, the other side made strong.

**HOW IT FAILS**

Critique of the wrong thing.

**THE ONE RULE**

**Name what you are defending and what would change your mind.**

**AT SCHOOL**

*(made-up example)* Before a debate: "I'm arguing the town should build the bypass, because of air quality on the high street. I'd change my mind if the traffic just moved to the villages. Attack that reason."

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# The Librarian

WHAT HAS BEEN SAID

**YOU EXPECT**

a synthesis of what is known: what has been said, not what is.

**HOW IT FAILS**

Confident retrieval of what was never said.

**THE ONE RULE**

**Check the citation exists and says what is claimed.**

**AT SCHOOL**

*(made-up example)* For a geography project you ask for five sources on coastal erosion, with author, year and title. You look each one up. One does not exist; another is about a different coast.

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# Which mode are you in?

HOW TO USE THESE CARDS

**BEFORE YOU TYPE,**

pick the card for the help you want, and say it out loud or write it in your mode log.

**THEN DO THE ONE RULE**

on the card. It is the check that stance needs.

**WHO CHECKS?**

Every piece of work with AI help has a checker, named before you start. The checker is never the chat that wrote it.

**MOSTLY AN ORACLE?**

Most people are. Try the Tutor next time.

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